

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Suspect charged: Chicago man allegedly admits to fatal shooting of two Israeli Embassy workers in DC

FBI search: Agents cordon off North Side apartment of UIC graduate who says he ‘did it for Palestine’

‘Act of cowardice’



FBI agents leave the Albany Park apartment building on Thursday where Elias Rodriguez, a suspect in the fatal shootings, is believed to have lived. AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Couple killed by gunman outside Jewish museum were days away from getting engaged, family says

By John Yoon, Isabel Kershner and Natan Odenheimer
The New York Times

Sarah Milgrim’s parents didn’t know that Yaron Lischinsky was planning to propose to her until after the couple was killed by a gunman in Washington, D.C., on Wednesday night.

Her parents had assumed that marriage was in the picture. Milgrim, who grew up in Prairie Village, Kansas, had met Lischinsky shortly after joining the Israeli Embassy a year and a half ago to organize missions and visits by delegations. Lischinsky, a researcher at the embassy, had met her parents several times.

“He was incredible,” Milgrim’s father, Robert Milgrim, said in an interview. “He was very much like Sarah: passionate, extremely intelligent, dedicated to what he does, always on the cause of what’s right.”

A few months ago, Sarah Milgrim, 26, told her parents that she planned to travel with Lischinsky, 30, to meet his family in Jerusalem for the first time. What they didn’t know, and would only learn after the shooting, is that he had bought an engagement ring before the trip.

With the couple set to fly to Israel on Sunday, Milgrim’s mother,

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Sarah Milgrim, left, and Yaron Lischinsky, the Israeli Embassy aides who were shot dead outside an event at the Capital Jewish Museum in Washington on Wednesday night, were a couple and close to getting engaged, relatives said. THE MILGRIM FAMILY VIA THE NEW YORK TIMES

By Jonathan Bullington, Jason Meisner and Caroline Kubzansky
Chicago Tribune

A Chicago man who railed on social media against the ongoing bombing of Gaza fatally shot two Israeli Embassy employees near a Jewish museum in Washington on Wednesday before allegedly admitting to a police officer he “did it for Palestine,” according to federal charges unsealed Thursday afternoon.

Elias Rodriguez, 31, of the 4700 block of North Troy Street, is charged in U.S. District Court in Washington with first-degree murder, murder of a foreign official, causing a death with a firearm and discharging a firearm in

Turn to Suspect, Page 4

Calumet and Chicago rivers ‘pretty clean,’ report shows

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

Before an outing on the Chicago River, coaches from a year-round local rowing team of breast cancer survivors check forecasts for storms and lightning, strong winds or air pollutants to decide whether it’s safe to head out. During the summer months, they also get in the habit of checking for bacteria levels from human poop in the water.

It might seem gross to think about, but for the group, it’s necessary because some of its members have compromised



Dale Landmann monitors bacteria levels in the Chicago River under the DuSable Bridge on May 16. E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

immune systems due to their illness or treatment. In the last year, more often than not, test results reassured them that contact with the river wouldn’t pose a health risk.

Between Memorial Day and

Labor Day in 2024, microbial water quality readings in the Chicago and Calumet rivers showed that conditions remained good or low-caution

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Arrests inside immigration court sparking fear in city

By Laura Rodríguez Presa, Madeline Buckley and Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

Federal agents appeared to have arrested several people inside Chicago’s immigration court on Wednesday and Thursday, lawyers told the Tribune, in what seems to be the latest escalation in President Donald Trump’s bid to enact mass deportations.

Throughout Wednesday, groups of men were spotted detaining individuals inside the downtown courthouse, with many of those agents wearing

badges or verbally identifying themselves as U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers, according to four attorneys. More arrests were seen Thursday, according to the National Immigrant Justice Center.

An ICE spokesperson did not provide comment, but a Tribune reporter also witnessed three individuals being taken into custody by men dressed in plainclothes and holding clipboards early Wednesday afternoon. Their lawyer, Essam Abdallah, told the Tribune his clients are immigrants who have been in the

Turn to Arrests, Page 2

Blackhawks get their guy

Hawks land the next steward of their rebuild in Lightning assistant Jeff Blashill. **Chicago Sports**

A Paul Simon ‘celebration’

Absorb the legend’s music with a heady concert series at city’s Symphony Center. **Review in A+E**

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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